

LONDON ROAD SURGERY

Website: www.thelondonroadsurgery.co.uk

Telephone: 01268 765533

NEWSLETTER February 2025

Welcome to the practice newsletter. In it you will find some useful information, especially if you are not able to use a computer. **However, there are references to important websites and it might be useful if you have a friend or relative who could gain access to the relevant information for you. This is a bumper issue this month as there are lots of campaigns listed for March 2025. Please see end of the newsletter.**

All prescription requests must be made online via the NHS App or via Online Services accessed by using the London Road Surgery website. Alternatively, you can post your request through our letterbox or send it by Royal Mail.

We are experiencing a high demand for appointments please ask your local Pharmacist for advice or use e-consult online consultation and receive a reply within 48 hours. Pharmacy First is a new campaign that allows the Pharmacists to treat 7 conditions. Please ask your pharmacist for more information.

e-consults or Online Consultations

We have available via the website www.thelondonroadsurgery.co.uk a platform for consulting online a clinical or admin queries. This is called e-consult. Please follow the instructions to submit your query. You will get a response within 48 hours.

New Reception Staff

We have new staff who have joined our reception team. Please be patient while they deal with your queries. Our reception staff are now called Healthcare Navigators because they can sign post you to Health Care Professionals who support the doctors in primary care.

Thank you for your kind comments for some of our new reception staff.

These staff are trained professionals and if unable to support you they will refer you back to the doctor. These are: Pharmacists, Paramedic, Social Prescriber, Mental Health First Contact Practitioner, and retail Pharmacists. We also use the weekend appointments available to all the practices in Wickford.

Ideas and Suggestions

Please let us know if you have any ideas or suggestions by writing to us via the email address or by post.

Thank you.

Veteran Friendly Accreditation

We are accredited as an Armed Forces veteran friendly accredited GP practice. Dr Richards is the Lead GP for this.

Patient Contact Details

Please keep us up to date with your contact details either by popping a note through our letterbox or by emailing us at londonroadsurgery@nhs.net Last month we had 660 patients with no mobile number on their record. Please email us with your mobile number and email address.

Primary Care Network (PCN) Staff

In line with NHS England guidance and the development of Primary Care Networks (PCN's) some new allied Health Care Professionals have joined the team at London Road Surgery. We have a Paramedic and 2 Advanced Nurse Practitioners who can treat minor illness. We also have a Nurse Practitioner who is studying to become an Advanced Nurse Practitioner. These staff members join the doctors and nurses and the new Social Prescriber and Mental Health First Contact Practitioner to help you. NEW – we have a Physio who works here on Tuesday and Friday who you can see by booking in with reception.

To assist you with your request to see a clinician our Receptionists/Care Navigators will ask you the reason for your appointment so that they can guide you to the correct clinician for your condition.

PCN Pharmacists – now work at the surgery and you may be contacted by them before you see a doctor. They can sort minor illnesses as well as review all medication.

We encourage self-care and there are lots of information on our website and NHS App.

Local Pharmacists are happy to discuss with you about your minor illness and we can refer you to them using our clinical system. They will call you back in a few hours.

Basildon & Brentwood CCG website also has Health Information

<https://basildonandbrentwoodccg.nhs.uk/>

Looking after yourself

We continue to offer free health checks for patients aged 40-74 who have not had a health check in 5 years and for those over 75 years. Please call reception to book your health check with Natalie or Mel our Paramedic.

Contacting Us

Please do not use our email address to send any clinical queries to us. Please call the practice to make an appointment or use e-consult (see above). Please use NHS App to order repeat medication. We can process requests faster this way.

Patient Group Activity

We have a new noticeboard in our Waiting Room and the Chair – Sue Bunney will be coordinating new campaigns for the group to action. They have recently done a survey and their minutes are on our website. The group will be promoting the NHS App.

**Next Patient Group meeting: Monday 24 March 2025 at 2pm
All are welcome!**

Patient Newsletter on Website

We understand that lots of our patients are unable to view our website if you know a member of your community is housebound or without any computer access, please print this and deliver it to them. London Road Surgery thank you for this kindness.

Healthwatch Essex

<https://healthwatchessex.org.uk/>

Is an independent charity set up under the Health & Social Care Act 2012 and they use your voice to improve health and care in Essex. They undertake high-quality research and engagement to uncover your experience of services and use it to shape health and care. They are also proud hosts to the Essex Neurology Network.